was very energetic and had an aura of authority that hid an exceedingly kind and giving heart, says Ratan.

The couple was childless when Sir Ratan died. When a Parsi family does not have a male child to be its legal heir, it is common to adopt one from the extended family. An heir is considered necessary for the Uthamna ceremony that is held on the third day of a Parsi's demise, when charitable donations are solicited in the name of the deceased. In keeping with this tradition, at a family meeting headed by Jamsetji's older son Sir Dorabji Tata, his wife Lady (Meherbai) Tata and Sir Nowroji Saklatvala, a relative, a decision was taken that Lady (Navajbai) Tata would adopt a boy. The search began, and it was decided that she would adopt one of Hormusji and Ratanbai Tata's five sons. Ratanbai was the daughter of Cooverbai, Jamsetji's wife's sister and the late Sir Ratan's favourite cousin. The decision on which child would be adopted was left to Sir Dorabji; he chose Navroji (Naval) Hormusji Tata, the third son.

Though Naval's mother was the niece of the founder, little was known of the lineage of his father, Hormusji. Naval had attempted to trace his ancestry and prepared a document titled 'My Branch of Tata Family' in which he stated that his great-grandfather Navroji Tata was the second cousin of the founder, Jamsetji. The archivist of the Tata Archives, Pune, R.P. Narla, while confirming that the document was prepared by Naval Tata, said that beyond Naval's father, the Tata Archives had no 'reference' to his ancestry.

During the examination of certain historical documents in the custody of Parsi priests for this book, however, it came to light, for the first time, that Naval was also related by blood to Jamsetji. The original records of the 'genealogy' of the Tata family, which are with the 'Bhagarsath' section of the Parsi priests at the Navsari Atashbehram and Vadi Daremeher Fund, reveal that Bhikha Tata was the common ancestor of both Jamsetji and Naval Tata. In a manner, this relationship makes Ratan the only chairman of Tata Sons who is related to the founder through both blood (paternally) and association (maternally).

Naval was around fourteen when he was adopted. His father, Hormusji, who worked at the Ahmedabad Advance Textile Mills and was the sole breadwinner of the family, had died suddenly of heart failure in 1908, leaving his family in deep penury. He 'was rated very high as a spinner' and had the reputation of being a 'thorough gentleman'. Naval's widowed